

Open source Lightroom alternative available for Windows users

Those who are looking for a cheaper alternative to Lightroom to manage and process raw photos, the free and open source software, darktable, is now finally available for Windows users.

Photographers have been using darktable on Mac and Linux based systems since its release in 2009. Now, after eight years, darktable has been officially ported to Windows in its new version 2.4.0. It is a software that contains a set of photo editing features that help you do non-destructive post-processing on raw files, especially in large batches.

For quite some time, photographers have been requesting a Windows build. The project leaders had refrained from venturing into Windows due to a lack of people who could be dedicated to maintaining it in the long term. Recently, developer Peter Budai brought new hope for Windows users.



In its announcement, sources at darktable shared their intent to support it in the future too. The release also highlighted a few missing features such as the lack of printing support and the need for installing special drivers for tethering. The new version comes with its own set of bugs (TIFF import and export don't support non-ASCII characters in file names) too.

In addition to a Windows build, darktable version 2.4.0 has a host of improvements including a new module for haze removal, undo support for masks, intelligent grouping of undo steps, and more.

Support has ended for OpenWRT releases prior to 15.05 (which means no security or bug fixes), and the project team has warned that OpenWRT CC 15.05 patches will run behind time for a while since it's "...not yet fully integrated into our release automation."

"The LEDE 17.01 release will continue to get full security and bug fix support from both source code and binary releases," the project team announced.

Capsule8 launches open source sensor capable of detecting meltdown

Capsule8 has created the first practical strategies for detecting meltdowns of Linux based systems and is now making these available to the public.



It has unveiled the beta version of the Capsule8 open source attack detection sensor. The new sensor is used as part of the Capsule8 Protect platform, and will facilitate real-time detection of Linux based attacks.

Next, the company has announced providing open source proof-of-concept code for the fast and efficient detection of the Intel Meltdown vulnerability, with minimal false positives.

"Remediation works but it's painful in terms of the time and resources required. The necessary upgrades lead to huge cost and stability risks," said Dino Dai Zovi, co-founder and CTO of Capsule8.

The Capsule8 open source sensor is built to support an efficient gathering of system level telemetry, much like the commonly used auditd, but is built for performance under load. Currently, Capsule8's Protect platform is in beta mode. It uses the sensor to do real-time attack disruption, enabling people to detect zero-day attacks and respond to them in real-time.

Anyone using the Capsule8 open source attack detection sensor can build their own attack strategies. As an example, the company has provided a strategy for detection of the recent Meltdown vulnerability under an Apache licence.

The sensor works for any out-of-the-box version of Linux, dating back to the Linux 2.6 kernel.

"Now, organisations can specifically detect attempts to exploit these problems, giving them the ability to monitor for the problem and respond in real-time, up until they're able to remediate appropriately," said John Viega, co-founder and CEO of Capsule8.

'Open Source Initiative' turns 20 this February!

The term 'open source' was coined at a 'strategy session' held on February 3, 1998, in Palo Alto, California. In the same month, the 'Open Source Initiative' was founded. It was created as a general educational and advocacy organisation to raise awareness about the superiority of an open development process, and hence drive its adoption.

The Open Source Initiative (OSI) has been raising awareness and promoting the adoption of open source software since it was founded. In 2018, it is celebrating the 20th anniversary of open source. This is a huge milestone for everyone involved with technology. Nowadays, open source is ubiquitous, recognised across industries as a fundamental component to infrastructure, as well as a critical factor for driving innovation.

